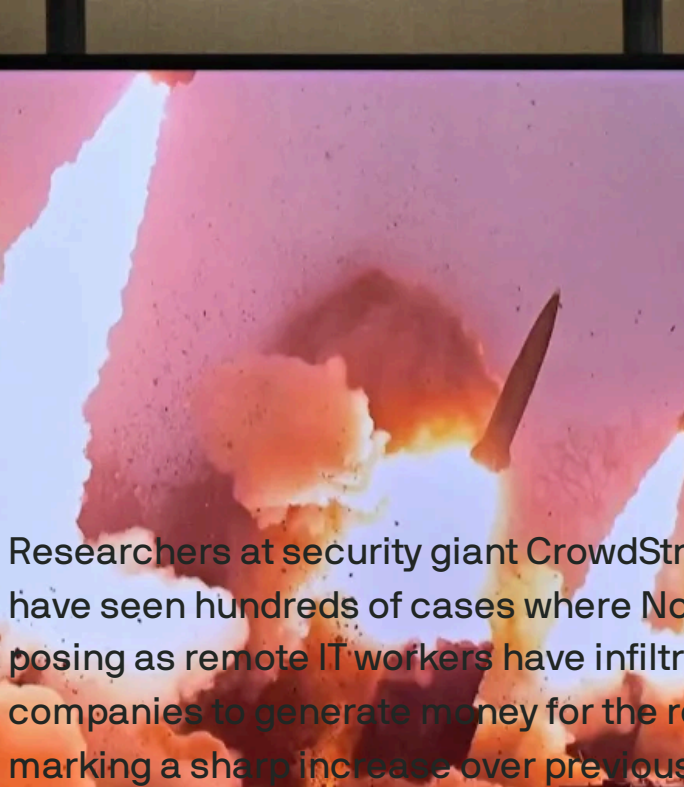


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SECURITY



North Korean spies posing as remote workers have infiltrated hundreds of companies, says CrowdStrike



Researchers at security giant CrowdStrike say they have seen hundreds of cases where North Koreans posing as remote IT workers have infiltrated companies to generate money for the regime, marking a sharp increase over previous years.

Per [CrowdStrike's latest threat hunting report](#), the company has identified more than 320 incidents over the past 12 months, up from 120 in the year earlier, in which North Koreans gained fraudulent employment at Western companies working remotely as developers.

The scheme relies on North Koreans using false identities, resumes, and work histories to gain employment and earn money for the regime, as well as allowing access for the workers to steal data from the companies they work for and later extort them. The aim is to generate funds for North Korea's sanctioned nuclear weapons program, which has so far made [billions of dollars for the regime](#) to date.

It's not known exactly how many North Korean IT workers are currently working for unknowing U.S. companies, but some have estimated the number to be in the thousands.

According to CrowdStrike, the North Korean IT workers, which the company calls “Famous Chollima” using its naming scheme of hacking groups, rely on generative AI and other AI-powered

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tools to draft resumes and modify or “deepfake” their appearance during remote interviews.

While [the scheme is not new](#), North Koreans are increasingly succeeding at getting jobs, despite sanctions preventing U.S. companies from hiring North Korean workers.

CrowdStrike said in its report that one of the ways to prevent hiring sanctioned workers is by implementing better identity verification processes during the hiring phase. TechCrunch has anecdotally heard of some crypto-focused companies asking prospective employees to say critical things about North Korea’s leader, Kim Jong Un, in an effort to weed out potential spies. The would-be North Korean employees are often highly monitored and surveilled, making any such request impossible and likely outing the fraudulent worker.

Over the past year, the U.S. Department of Justice has sought to disrupt these operations by going after the U.S.-based facilitators who help [run and operate the scheme](#) for their North Korean bosses. These operations have included [targeting the individuals who run “laptop farm” operations](#), which include racks of open laptops used by the North Koreans to remotely do their work as if they were physically located in the United States.

Prosecutors said [in a June indictment](#) that one North Korean operation stole the identities of 80 individuals in the U.S. between 2021 and 2024 to get remote work at more than 100 U.S. companies.

Topics: [CrowdStrike](#) [Crypto](#) [crypto](#) [cybersecurity](#)

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SECURITY

US government takes down major North Korean ‘remote IT workers’ operation

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

11:13 AM PDT · June 30, 2025

The U.S. Department of Justice announced on Monday that it had taken several enforcement

actions against North Korea’s money-making operations, which [rely on undercover remote IT workers inside American tech companies](#) to raise funds for the regime’s nuclear weapons program, as well as to steal data and cryptocurrency.

As part of the DOJ’s multi-state effort, the government announced the arrest and [indictment](#) of U.S. national Zhenxing “Danny” Wang, who allegedly ran a years-long fraud scheme from New Jersey to sneak remote North Korean IT workers inside U.S. tech companies. According to the indictment, the scheme generated more than \$5 million in revenue for the North Korean regime.

Wang is accused of conspiracy to commit wire fraud, money laundering, and identity theft.

The feds also [indicted eight more people](#) who participated in the scheme: six Chinese nationals and two Taiwanese citizens, who are accused of conspiring to commit wire fraud, money laundering, identity theft, hacking, and to violate sanctions.

“Thousands of North Korean cyber operatives have been trained and deployed by the regime to blend into the global digital workforce and systematically target U.S. companies,” Leah B. Foley, U.S. Attorney for the District of Massachusetts, was quoted as saying.

From 2021 until 2024, the co-conspirators allegedly impersonated more than 80 U.S. individuals to get remote jobs at more than 100 American companies, causing \$3 million in damages due to legal fees, data breach remediation efforts, and more.

The group is said to have run laptop farms inside the United States, which the North Korean IT workers could essentially use as proxies to hide their provenance, according to the DOJ. At times,

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they used hardware devices known as [keyboard-video-mouse \(KVM\) switches](#), which allow one person to control multiple computers from a single keyboard and mouse. The group allegedly also ran shell companies inside the U.S. to make it seem like the North Korean IT workers were affiliated with legitimate local companies, and to receive money that would then be transferred abroad, the DOJ said.

The fraudulent scheme allegedly also involved the North Korean workers stealing sensitive data, such as source code, from the companies they were working for, such as from an unnamed California-based defense contractor “that develops artificial intelligence-powered equipment and technologies.”

The DOJ said the FBI carried out searches earlier in June on 21 locations across 14 states, which were allegedly hosting laptop farms used by the North Korean scheme. The FBI seized 137 laptops as a result of the raids.

The feds also said they seized at least 21 web domains, 29 financial accounts used to launder tens of thousands of dollars, and more than 70 laptops and remote access devices, including KVMs.

Five North Korean nationals were indicted for wire fraud and money laundering after they stole more than \$900,000 in crypto from two unnamed companies, thanks to their use of fake or stolen identities, the DOJ said.

Topics: [crypto](#) [cybersecurity](#) [fraud](#) [hacking](#)

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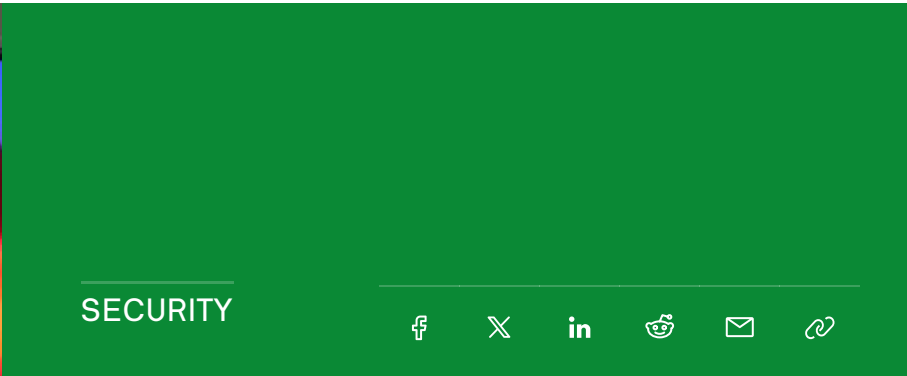
Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

Senior Reporter, Cybersecurity | X butterfly mail

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Security researchers say they have high confidence that North Korean hackers were behind a recent intrusion at enterprise software company JumpCloud because of a mistake the hackers made.

Mandiant, which is assisting one of JumpCloud's affected customers, attributed [the breach](#) to hackers working for North Korea's Reconnaissance General Bureau, or RGB, a hacking unit that targets cryptocurrency companies and steals passwords from executives and security teams. North Korea has long used crypto thefts to fund its sanctioned nuclear weapons program.

In [a blog post](#), Mandiant said the hacking unit, which it calls UNC4899 (since it's a new, unclassified threat group), mistakenly exposed their real-world IP addresses. The North Korean hackers would often use commercial VPN services to mask their IP addresses, but on "many occasions" the VPNs failed to work or the hackers did not use them when accessing the victim's network, exposing their access from Pyongyang.

Mandiant said its evidence supports that this was "an OPSEC slip up," referring to operational security — the way in which hackers try to prevent information about their activity leaking as part of their hacking campaigns. The researchers said they also uncovered additional infrastructure used in this intrusion that was previously used by hacks attributed to North Korea.

"North Korea-nexus threat actors continue to improve their cyber offensive capabilities in order to steal cryptocurrency. Over the past year, we've seen them conduct multiple supply chain attacks, poison legitimate software, and develop and deploy custom malware onto MacOS systems," said Mandiant's CTO Charles Carmakal. "They ultimately want to compromise companies with

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cryptocurrency and they've found creative paths to get there. But they also make mistakes that have helped us attribute several intrusions to them."

SentinelOne and CrowdStrike [also confirmed](#) North Korea was behind the JumpCloud intrusion.

JumpCloud said in a short post last week that fewer than five of its corporate customers and less than 10 devices were [targeted by the North Korean hacking campaign](#). JumpCloud reset its customer API keys after reporting an intrusion in June.

JumpCloud has more than 200,000 enterprise customers, including GoFundMe, ClassPass, and Foursquare.

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Spyhide stalkerware is spying on tens of thousands of phones



A phone surveillance app called Spyhide is stealthily collecting private phone data from tens of thousands of Android devices around the world, new data shows. Spyhide is a widely used

stalkerware (or spouseware) app that is planted on a victim's phone, often by someone with knowledge of their passcode. The app is designed to stay ... [Continue reading](#)

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North Korean hackers blamed for record spike in crypto thefts in 2025

Zack Whittaker — 7:51 AM PDT · July 17, 2025

Hackers have stolen more than \$2 billion in crypto during the first half of 2025, according to new data from crypto analysis firm Chainalysis, marking the worst year-to-date on record for crypto thefts.

The blockchain analysis company [said Thursday in a new report](#) that the \$2.17 billion stolen during the first half of 2025 has already surpassed the amount of crypto lost last year. Not only that, the amount of cryptocurrency stolen during the first six months of 2025 was about 17% higher than the same period in 2022, which was previously the worst year on record for stolen crypto.

Much of the stolen crypto this year was attributed to a single breach at crypto exchange Bybit, which saw [North Korean hackers steal more than \\$1.4 billion in crypto](#), much of it [subsequently laundered](#) and funneled into the North Korean regime, per [the FBI](#).

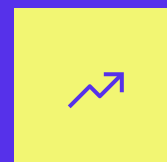
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Chainalysis said the Bybit hack falls within a broader pattern of North Korean hacks, which have “become increasingly central to the regime’s sanctions evasion strategies.”

North Korea, largely cut off from the outside world and the international banking system, has become a formidable threat in recent years by targeting Western companies to steal cryptocurrency with the aim of funding its sanctioned nuclear weapons program. North Korea has also [relied on thousands of remote IT workers](#), who infiltrate tech companies to earn a wage, steal intellectual property, and then extort companies into paying so as not to publish their sensitive files.

According to [an earlier Chainalysis report](#), North Korean hackers were blamed for almost two-thirds of all crypto hacks during 2024.

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